

Using creative tools

The good news is that there are many tools available to help you tackle the stages of the problem-solving cycle. These can be used by individuals, but most are more useful as part of a general meeting to encourage ideas.

IDENTIFICATION

Fishbone (or “cause and effect”) diagram—
exploring the root causes of a problem
and its contributing factors

REDEFINITION

Goal orientation—restating the problem to
focus on what you are really trying to solve
Perspective—looking at the problem differently

EXPLORATION

Brainstorming—pooling ideas from a team
Radical ideas—encouraging wild thinking
Random link—forcing a random connection

SELECTION

Voting—a simple vote to choose the idea
Implement-ability matrix—plotting your ideas
on a chart to compare the payoffs they offer

IMPLEMENTATION AND REVIEW

Measure and compare—reviewing an
innovation project once it has been
implemented to measure its success

